

Niraj Desai

Principal Software Engineer · Cloud Infrastructure & Distributed Systems

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SUMMARY

Principal Software Engineer with 13+ years building enterprise-scale distributed systems and cloud infrastructure. Currently at Salesforce leading engineering on Argus — the central time-series metrics platform — and on a conversational, LLM-native telemetry surface that unifies metrics, logs, and traces behind tool-calling APIs. Earlier work spans multi-PB log analytics, multi-cloud Splunk migration, and Kubernetes adoption across the monitoring stack.

EXPERIENCE

Principal Software Engineer — Argus Metrics Platform

2024 – Present

Salesforce · Argus · Monitoring Cloud · San Francisco Bay Area

- Lead engineering on Argus, the central time-series metrics platform serving multi-billion-datapoint-per-minute scale across the monitoring stack
- Own the high-throughput Java ingestion path: Kafka consumers persisting to HBase via OpenTSDB, with Elasticsearch-backed scope discovery powering dashboard and alert authoring
- Building an LLM-native telemetry surface that unifies metrics, logs, and traces behind a conversational interface, with Slack as a first-class client and tool-calling APIs that let Claude and other model runtimes query observability data directly
- Extended the Argus query engine with cross-namespace joins, expression nesting, and downsampling — used by SLO, capacity, and performance dashboards across the org

Principal Software Engineer — Log Analytics

Aug 2021 – 2024

Salesforce · Log Analytics · Monitoring Cloud · San Francisco Bay Area

- Led technical strategy for the central log analytics platform processing 1.6 PB/day, spanning cloud migration, Kubernetes adoption, and developer tooling
- Drove Splunk migration from private DCs to multi-cloud (AWS, Azure, GCP) with no data loss during cutover and steady-state availability above 99.99%
- Architected a geo-distributed federation layer across 6 regions enabling sub-second cross-region log search across the global estate
- Led Splunk-on-Kubernetes migration with custom operators across 1,600+ pods; introduced an Istio service mesh with mTLS for east-west traffic
- Built MCP servers wiring Cursor and other IDEs directly into Splunk so engineers can query production logs from their editor during incident triage
- Drove a CentOS 7 → 8 host migration across 12,000+ production hosts, coordinating with 20+ application teams and shipping automated rollback for safety
- Spearheaded an ML-based log anomaly detection pipeline that surfaces unknown-unknown signal during incidents

Senior Software Engineer

Jul 2019 – Aug 2021

Salesforce · Log Analytics · Monitoring Cloud · San Francisco Bay Area

- Operated the Splunk indexer fleet at multi-PB-per-day ingest, with deployment and configuration managed entirely through CI/CD

- Led GovCloud product standardization and customer onboarding across 3 GovCloud regions, including 12-month retention and audit controls
- Tightened the deploy pipeline so production rollouts could be cut multiple times per day instead of weekly

Senior Software Engineer

May 2016 – Jun 2019

Oracle · Fusion Development Management · Test Engineering · Redwood Shores, CA

- Built CI/CD for Oracle Fusion CRM/HCM SaaS fleet, including Jenkins job-management tooling for the dev org
- Authored shared Jenkins libraries (Groovy, shell) and notification plumbing that cut validation turnaround for downstream teams
- Managed cloud infrastructure automation for QA and developer environments

Staff Software Engineer

Sep 2015 – May 2016

E*TRADE · WebDev · Robo Advisor · New York, NY

- Built Spring MVC controllers and REST/SOAP services for the automated Robo Advisor trading flows
- Documented APIs with Swagger and added unit-test coverage with JUnit

Application System Engineer

Apr 2014 – Aug 2015

Wells Fargo · CEO Wires (via Teamsoft) · New York, NY

- Worked on the wire-transfer platform: Oracle Coherence cache layer, SOA/BPEL orchestration, OSB proxy layer, MFA via RSA tokens, and TANDEM socket integrations for real-time processing

Programmer Analyst

Sep 2011 – Mar 2014

Wells Fargo · CEO Wires (via GSS Infotech) · New York, NY

- Built MVC components for the wire-transfer system on Java EE / WebSphere with Coherence as the data layer; REST and SOAP integrations; logging via Log4j/SLF4J

SKILLS

Distributed Systems: Apache Kafka · HBase · OpenTSDB · Elasticsearch · Service Mesh / Istio · Oracle Coherence

Cloud & Infrastructure: Kubernetes · Terraform · AWS · Azure · GCP · Spinnaker · CI/CD · GovCloud

Languages & Frameworks: Java · Python · Go · TypeScript · Spring · React

Observability & AI: Splunk · OpenTSDB / Argus · OpenTelemetry · MCP Servers · LLM Tool-Calling APIs · Anomaly Detection

ACHIEVEMENTS

Splunk .conf Speaker. Presented "Indexer Clustering at Scale" at Splunk .conf — covering operational lessons from running a large indexer footprint.

Open Source Contributor. Contributor to the Splunk Operator for Kubernetes (15+ PRs merged), the project that lets organizations run enterprise Splunk declaratively on Kubernetes.

LLM-Native Observability. Built one of Salesforce's first conversational telemetry surfaces — tool-calling APIs that let LLMs query metrics and logs directly, plus an MCP integration that pulls production log access into the IDE.

Petabyte-Scale Operations. Systems under ownership operate at multi-billion datapoints per minute on Argus and 1.6 PB per day on the log analytics side — among the larger monitoring deployments in industry.

GovCloud Compliance. Established the compliance framework for the log analytics product across 3 GovCloud regions, including retention, access controls, and audit posture.

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Bioinformatics

New Jersey Institute of Technology, Newark, NJ · January 2011

Bachelor of Engineering, Biotechnology

MVJ College of Engineering, Bangalore, India · June 2008